



CUSTOMER & MVP BLUEPRINT

AI Career Mentor for Students

Derived from Startup Validation Report | India Market | June 2025

Prepared by AI Product Strategy Engine

72/100

Customer Clarity

80/100

Problem Severity

65/100

PMF Potential

30/100

MVP Readiness

Verdict: ■ Promising but Unvalidated — Strong problem signal in a large market, but zero primary research completed. This blueprint defines exactly what to build, who to build it for, and what to do in the next 30 days.

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What this blueprint is based on

Field	Detail
Product	AI-powered personalised career mentor for college students
Core Problem	Students lack guidance on what to learn, build, and do to get hired
Target Users	19–23 yr college students, India, Tier-1 & Tier-2 cities
Market Size	SAM \$380M 43M+ students in India
Validation	Observational only — no interviews, MVP, or waitlist
Stage	Pre-idea → needs 30-day discovery sprint before building
Revenue Model	Freemium B2C (Rs.0–299/mo) + B2B institutional licensing
Key Insight	No competitor owns the end-to-end 'career OS for students' position

2. IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

Your best early adopter

Dimension	B2C Student (Primary)	B2B Institution (Secondary)
Who	2nd–4th year college student	Placement / Training Dept.
Location	Tier-1 & Tier-2 Indian cities	Any college 1,000+ students
Pain Level	High — confused, anxious, behind	High — low placement rates
Budget	Rs. 0–299/month	Rs. 50K–5L/year
Channel	Instagram, WhatsApp, LinkedIn	LinkedIn, EdTech expos, MoUs
Job-to-be-Done	'Tell me what to learn and do next'	'Improve our placement %'
Decision Time	Minutes (self-serve)	Weeks–months (committee)

3. BUYER PERSONA

Arjun — The Confused Engineer

Arjun, 21 — B.Tech CSE, Year 3, Pune

CGPA: 7.2 | Mid-tier private college | Smartphone-native

Goals: Land a product-company internship; know which skills matter; build 2 impressive projects; get placed before graduation.

Frustrations: Done 10 courses with no direction; placement cell gives only a resume template; can't afford Rs.2,000/session mentors; peer comparison anxiety from LinkedIn.

Discovery: Instagram reels, YouTube, college WhatsApp groups.

Converts when: Sees a personalised roadmap in under 3 minutes.

4. TOP 10 CUSTOMER PAIN POINTS

Ranked by severity × frequency

#	Pain Point	Severity	Freq.	MVP Priority
1	No structured 'what to learn next' roadmap	Critical	Daily	■ Core
2	Can't map skills to specific job roles/companies	Critical	Daily	■ Core
3	Fails internship screening rounds — doesn't know why	High	Monthly	■ Core
4	Human mentors too expensive (Rs.2K+/session)	High	Always	■ Core
5	Doesn't know which projects impress recruiters	High	Weekly	■ Phase 2
6	Certification overload — AWS vs GCP vs Azure	High	Weekly	■ Phase 2
7	Resume doesn't reflect real skills	Medium	Once	■ Phase 2
8	Peer comparison anxiety on LinkedIn	Medium	Daily	■ Won't Fix
9	College placement support is generic/reactive	Medium	Semester	■ Phase 2
10	No visibility into hiring trends by company	Medium	Monthly	■ Phase 2

5. CUSTOMER JOURNEY

Awareness → Consideration → Purchase → Retention

Stage	Touchpoint	Student Thought	Your Move	Metric
■ Aware	IG reel / YouTube / friend referral	'This looks like what I need'	Relatable career-anxiety content	CTR, Views
■ Consider	Landing page + free skill quiz	'Will this actually work for me?'	Show sample roadmap — no sign-up	Quiz completions
■ Activate	Personalised roadmap reveal (<3 min)	'Wow — this is exactly my gap!'	Aha moment = instant roadmap	Time-to-roadmap
■ Purchase	Hit free plan limit	'I want the full 12-week plan'	Contextual upgrade prompt	Conversion %
■ Retain	Weekly nudges + milestone badges	'I'm making progress every week'	Streaks, check-ins, wins	WAU, D30 retention
■ Advocate	Internship win → posts on LinkedIn	'This got me my internship!'	Referral: 1 month free/referral	Referral rate

6-7. OBJECTIONS & BUYING TRIGGERS

Objection → Counter	Buying Triggers
■ 'ChatGPT is free and does this' ■ <i>Structured career UX + India data = ChatGPT can't match</i>	■ Semester 3-5 starts (placement anxiety kicks in)
■ 'I can't afford a subscription' ■ <i>Core free forever; Rs.99/mo = 1 cup of café coffee</i>	■ Friend posts an internship offer on LinkedIn
■ 'Another app I'll forget to use' ■ <i>Weekly AI nudges + progress streaks keep engagement</i>	■ Campus placement drive announced
■ 'Will this actually get me a job?' ■ <i>Show outcomes data + 30-day roadmap guarantee</i>	■ Failed a coding test / first-round rejection
■ 'My college already helps with placement' ■ <i>College support is generic & reactive — we're personalised</i>	■ Sees a LinkedIn post: '3rd year, 3 PPOs, no regrets'

8. MVP RECOMMENDATION

Build this — and only this — first

■ WHAT TO BUILD FIRST

Single core flow — the Personalised Career Roadmap Generator:

- Onboarding quiz (degree, goal, skills, timeline) — 5 questions max
- AI-generated 12-week learning roadmap (skills + resources)
- Weekly progress tracker with completion nudges
- 3 free roadmap weeks; upgrade for full access

■ WHAT NOT TO BUILD YET

Avoid scope creep — skip these in v1:

- Live human mentorship matching
- Internship / job board integration
- Resume builder
- Community / peer features
- Mobile app (web-first, then app)

Success Metric	Target (Day 90)	Why It Matters
Activated Users (saw roadmap)	500+	Proves product delivers value
D7 Retention	>40%	Proves habit loop works
Free → Paid Conversion	>5%	Proves willingness to pay
NPS Score	>45	Proves genuine delight
College Pilot Signups	3+	Unlocks B2B revenue path

9. MoSCoW PRIORITIZATION

For your v1 MVP build

MUST HAVE — Core MVP (Non-Negotiable)

- Onboarding quiz (degree, goal, current skills)
- AI-generated personalised career roadmap (12 weeks)
- Skill gap identification vs. target role
- Weekly progress tracker + completion nudges
- Freemium gate (3 free weeks, upgrade for full)

SHOULD HAVE — Strong v1 Additions

- Resource recommendations (courses, YouTube, docs) per roadmap step
- Project suggestions matched to career goal
- Email/WhatsApp weekly digest with next action
- Dashboard with completion streak and % progress

COULD HAVE — Nice to Have

- Certification recommendation engine (AWS vs GCP vs Azure)
- Peer comparison anonymised benchmarks ('Top 20% of CSE students')
- Resume score against target JD
- LinkedIn profile optimisation tips

WON'T HAVE — Out of Scope for v1

- Live mentor matching (v2+)
- Internship / job board (v2+)
- Mobile app (web-first, then app in v2)
- Community forums / peer chat (v3)
- AI mock interviews (v3)

10. PRICING HYPOTHESIS

Test these tiers before committing

Tier	Price	Includes	Target Segment	Goal
Free	Rs. 0/mo	3-week roadmap, basic skills gap	All students (acquisition)	Reach & virality
Pro	Rs. 99/mo	Full roadmap, resources, tracker	Motivated students	Primary revenue
Elite	Rs. 299/mo	Pro + project plans + cert guide	Placement-focused students	ARPU growth
College	Rs. 2L/yr	White-label for 500 students	Placement cells	B2B revenue

■ **Pricing Hypothesis to Test:** Run an A/B test — 50 students see Rs.99 pricing, 50 see Rs.149. Track conversion and churn over 30 days before locking in the price.

11. TOP 5 RISKS

Know these before you build

#	Risk	Prob.	Impact	Mitigation
1	ChatGPT adds structured career UX	High	High	Build moat via India data, college partnerships, outcomes tracking
2	Students won't pay — price sensitivity	High	High	Strong freemium; primary revenue via B2B college licensing
3	AI gives wrong career advice (hallucination)	Medium	High	Curated roadmap templates + source citations + user feedback loop
4	Founder builds alone — bandwidth risk	Medium	Medium	No-code MVP first (Bubble/Framer + GPT API); find co-founder
5	No validation before building	High	High	DO NOT BUILD until 30-day sprint is done — see plan below

12. 30-DAY MVP PLAN

Execute this before writing any code

Week	Focus	Key Actions	Output
Wk 1 Days 1–7	Validate Problem	20 student interviews (JTBD framework); score pain severity	Pain point ranking doc
Wk 2 Days 8–14	Validate Solution	Build landing page (Carrd); share in 5 college WhatsApp groups; collect 100+ emails	100+ waitlist signups
Wk 3 Days 15–21	Validate WTP	Show 3-tier pricing to 50 students; pitch 5 college placement cells for pilot	Pricing data + 1 pilot lead
Wk 4 Days 22–30	Prepare to Build	Define MVP scope; explore no-code tools; post for co-founder; draft 1-pager for angels	MVP spec + co-founder lead

13. FOUNDER ACTION SHEET

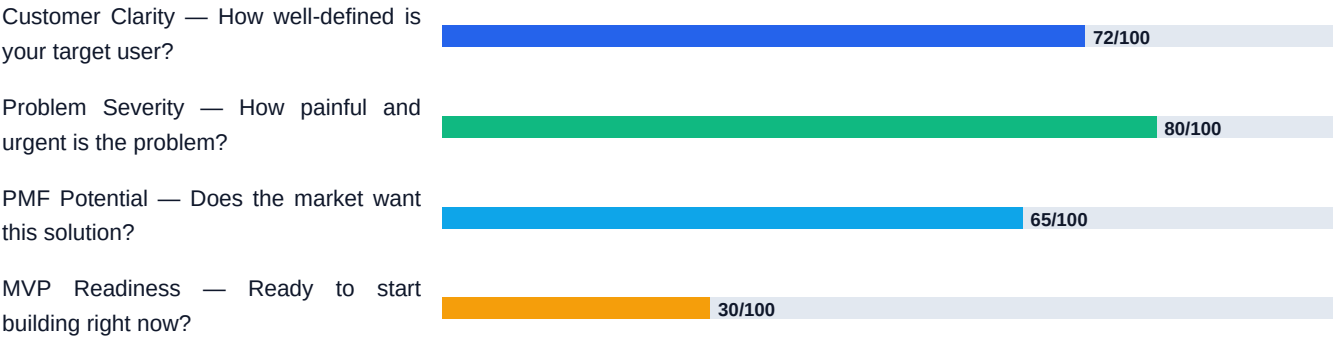
Top 10 next actions — start today

#	Action	Timeline	Priority
1	Write 10 problem hypotheses; choose top 3 to test	Day 1	■ Critical
2	Conduct 20 student interviews using JTBD framework	Days 2–5	■ Critical
3	Build a 1-page landing page with email capture	Days 6–7	■ Critical
4	Share landing page in 5+ college WhatsApp groups	Day 8	■ Critical
5	Call 10 students who signed up — validate in depth	Days 9–12	■ Critical
6	Test pricing with 50 students (Rs.99 vs Rs.149)	Days 13–15	■ High
7	Email 10 college placement officers for pilot talks	Days 14–18	■ High
8	Interview 5 HR managers on intern skill expectations	Days 16–20	■ High
9	Define v1 MVP scope (1 feature only — roadmap)	Day 21	■ High

#	Action	Timeline	Priority
10	Post for technical co-founder on LinkedIn + Angellist	Days 22–30	■ Medium

14. SCORES (0–100)

Current state assessment



15. FINAL VERDICT

■ PROMISING BUT UNVALIDATED

The AI Career Mentor targets a real, large, and underserved problem. The market timing is excellent. No competitor owns the end-to-end 'career OS for students' in India. The idea deserves to be built — **but not yet.**

Complete the 30-day validation sprint first. If you hit these gates:

■ 50 student interviews | ■ 100+ waitlist signups | ■ 1 college pilot lead | ■ Pricing data collected

→ **Then build the MVP. Then raise. Then scale.**